

Making the Most of Notion Business + AI

1 What is Notion Business + AI?

- **Plan and pricing:** Notion's Business and Enterprise plans include its AI features with no per-seat upcharge ¹. Users on lower tiers only receive a limited trial of AI.
- **Core capabilities:** Notion AI can search across your entire workspace and **connected apps**, automate meeting notes, perform deep research, generate and edit documents, autofill database rows with summaries or insights, translate text, create databases from scratch and even sort and filter your email inbox via Notion Mail AI ².
- **Model Context Protocol (MCP):** Notion's MCP enables third-party AI tools (including ChatGPT, Claude and Cursor) to **read from and write to your Notion pages in real time** ³. This bridge allows you to use external language models inside Notion or to pipe Notion context into those tools.

2 How Notion AI compares to ChatGPT, Copilot and VS Code extensions

Tool	Strengths	Weaknesses/ limitations	Integration options
Notion AI	Works inside your workspace; summarises docs, meeting recordings and PDFs; autofills databases; generates documents; has enterprise search; respects Notion permissions ² .	Generative quality is narrower than ChatGPT (less creative reasoning) but excels at structure and automation.	Native (no extra cost on Business); connects via MCP to external models ³ ; can be invoked inside pages or through slash-commands.
ChatGPT / Claude	State-of-the-art reasoning, creativity and long-form content; supports custom instructions; can ingest Notion context via MCP.	Works outside your workspace; manual copy-paste or integration needed; risk of context drift.	Use Notion MCP to connect ChatGPT to your workspace ³ ; or use third-party tools (e.g., Chat to Notion extension) to save conversations.
Microsoft Copilot (Office 365)	Integrated into Outlook, Word, Excel and Teams; can summarise emails and meetings, generate reports and code; good at editing and formula writing.	Limited cross-app knowledge; context may be restricted to the current document/mail.	Use Albato or Microsoft Power Automate to create triggers that send new emails or events into Notion as tasks or notes ⁴ .

Tool	Strengths	Weaknesses/ limitations	Integration options
Visual Studio Code + Notion	VS Code is a clean writing environment with Markdown support; Notion excels at planning, outlining and database tracking.	VS Code lacks structured project management; Notion's rich-text editor is less efficient for coding ⁵ .	Use the unofficial Notion ToDo extension to manage your Notion to-do lists from within VS Code ⁶ , or build an MCP integration via Cursor.

3 Building a seamless Notion-centric workflow

3.1 Centralise your knowledge base

- **Organise by domain:** Create top-level databases for **Projects**, **Knowledge base**, **Prompt Ledger**, **Contacts/Partners** and **Assets**. Each entry should have properties like status, tags, priority, last updated and responsible owner.
- **Use “Cubing” to give ideas depth:** The OverKill Hill philosophy advocates thinking in three axes—concept, mechanism and behaviour over time ⁷. When capturing ideas or frameworks in Notion, create a template that prompts you to fill in these three dimensions.
- **Store personal instructions and narratives:** Use pages like “Notion AI Personalization Instructions” to encode your tone, priorities and rules. The OverKill Hill personalization page instructs the AI to provide structured responses, iterate through versions and produce frameworks rather than paragraphs ⁸. Copy this style into your own Notion AI instructions page so the system knows how you want it to respond.
- **Link external documents:** Use Notion’s web clipper or embed capabilities to save research articles, PDFs, or ChatGPT conversations. Attach source links as properties so you can cite them later.
- **Enterprise search:** Notion AI’s search can sift through your pages, connected documents and external files to answer questions or pull up relevant snippets ⁹. Use it as the retrieval component in a RAG-style workflow—ask Notion AI to “summarise everything we know about X” before you move to ChatGPT for creative synthesis.

3.2 Automate capture and meeting notes

- **Meeting transcription:** Use Notion AI Meeting Notes or connect Zoom/Teams recordings to automatically produce **structured notes and action items** ².
- **Email/Calendar sync:** Use Albato or Power Automate to set up triggers that create a Notion database item whenever a relevant email arrives or a meeting is scheduled ¹⁰. You can filter on sender or keyword and map fields (subject, due date, attachments) into Notion properties.
- **Copilot to Notion:** When Copilot in Word or Outlook summarises emails or generates meeting recap, send that summary to Notion via the above automation. This keeps your knowledge base up to date without manual copying.
- **Task management inside VS Code:** The Notion ToDo extension allows you to fetch your task database and check off items directly from the editor ⁶. Use this when coding or writing to avoid context-switching.

3.3 Use Notion AI as a structured writer

- **Document drafting:** Notion AI can generate outlines, expand bullet points and translate content. Use the `/**` menu (or slash command) to ask Notion AI to write a first draft of a specification, blog post or project brief.
- **Research mode:** For deep dives, Notion AI can gather information from the web and compile detailed documents ⁹. Combine this with your internal knowledge base by summarising your own pages first, then letting AI search externally.
- **Autofill and tagging:** Create a database property called “Summary”. Use Notion AI to autofill this for each new item—e.g., summarising a research paper or summarising a ChatGPT conversation. You can also ask it to tag items with categories based on content.
- **Translation and multi-lingual work:** Notion AI translates content into different languages ¹¹. For global projects, maintain separate views filtered by language.

3.4 Connecting external AI tools via MCP

- **Connect ChatGPT/Claude:** Go to the Notion MCP gallery and link your ChatGPT Pro account ³. Once connected, ChatGPT can read the current page and write back the reply. This allows you to leverage ChatGPT’s reasoning while keeping context anchored in Notion.
- **Use Cursor for coding:** Cursor (an AI-powered code editor) integrates with Notion via MCP ¹². This is useful when generating documentation from code or summarising code reviews.
- **Best practices:** Start with single-player use cases, use descriptive page titles so AI tools understand context, and be mindful that MCP tools inherit your Notion permissions ¹³.

3.5 Publishing and social media workflows

- **Content calendar:** In Notion, create a database for social posts with properties for platform, publish date, status and metrics. Use templates for YouTube scripts, LinkedIn posts and Ko-fi articles.
- **Cross-platform automation:** Use Zapier or Make to trigger posts from Notion to LinkedIn, Twitter or WordPress. You can also schedule posts via Buffer or Hootsuite; Notion becomes the single source of truth while the automation platform handles distribution.
- **AI-assisted writing:** Ask Notion AI or ChatGPT (via MCP) to generate multiple headlines or variations for a post using SCAMPER (Substitute, Combine, Adapt, Modify, Put to another use, Eliminate, Reverse) to mutate ideas.

3.6 Leveraging mainstream prompt-engineering techniques

- **SCAMPER & RIS:** When brainstorming new products or frameworks, deliberately apply SCAMPER to each idea. Document each variation in a Notion database with columns for the SCAMPER letter and description.
- **Prompt Equilibrium and Agentic Harmony:** Part I of the OverKill Hill manifesto suggests designing prompts as **protocols** and using **cubic thought** ¹⁴. Build a Notion template called “Prompt Protocol” with sections for purpose, context, input structure, recursion rules and exit criteria. This encourages you to treat prompts as living systems rather than one-off queries.
- **Recursive salvage and ledgers:** Maintain a `Prompt Ledger` database. After each major ChatGPT or Copilot session, record the prompt, context, model used and a “salvage” note about what worked and what didn’t. This ledger becomes a retrieval source for RAG workflows and helps you refine prompts over time.

- **Constitutional prompting and Safe Completions:** When using ChatGPT via MCP, embed your constitutional rules (tone, forbidden topics, privacy constraints) into your Notion AI personalization instructions ⁸. Also, record safe fallback responses or refusal protocols for sensitive questions.
- **Optimizer-style iterations:** For creative outputs (scripts, designs), ask Notion AI to provide two versions (“clean” and “enhanced”) and iteratively refine them, capturing each version in Notion so you can trace the evolution of an idea ¹⁵.

4 Integrating with other tools in your ecosystem

4.1 Microsoft Office 365/Copilot

- **Outlook & Teams:** Set up Albato or Power Automate workflows to create Notion tasks or notes when you receive new emails that match certain criteria (e.g., a client request or newsletter) ⁴.
- **Word & Excel:** Use Copilot to draft reports or summarise spreadsheets, then export or sync the result to Notion. For example, after Copilot generates a project plan in Word, paste it into Notion and ask Notion AI to convert it into a structured database.

4.2 Visual Studio Code

- **Plan–build–reflect cycle:** Use Notion for outlining, project management and reflection; move to VS Code for execution (especially Markdown or coding); then return to Notion to log progress and metrics ¹⁶.
- **Notion ToDo extension:** Manage your tasks from inside VS Code. Connect via your Notion integration token and refresh to see to-do items; check them off without leaving the editor ⁶.
- **Markdown → Notion pipeline:** Use extensions like “Markdown All In One” for clean editing ¹⁷. Export `.md` files into Notion or sync via GitHub actions that push Markdown to Notion pages.

4.3 GitHub & internal repositories

- **Documentation:** Use Notion AI or ChatGPT to summarise pull requests and issues. Store these summaries in a `Dev Log` database.
- **Automated README updates:** When merging a PR, trigger a script that sends the updated README to Notion. Notion AI can then draft release notes.

5 Practical next steps for Jamie

1. **Define your workspace architecture:** Draft a high-level diagram of your Notion workspace – e.g., Team Spaces (Enterprise Architecture, Glee-fully Tools, OverKill Hill), databases (Projects, Knowledge, Prompt Ledger, Content Calendar) and integration channels (MCP, Albato, VS Code).
2. **Write your Notion AI personalization page:** Adapt the “Notion AI Personalization Instructions” page to reflect your own tone (you prefer density over length, confident clarity and strong opinions). Include rules about using corporate jargon when appropriate, applying SCAMPER, and highlighting verbosity and reasoning-effort dials.
3. **Connect ChatGPT via MCP:** Follow Notion’s MCP gallery to link your ChatGPT Pro account ³. Test by opening a page and asking ChatGPT to summarise it or brainstorm improvements.
4. **Automate email and meeting capture:** Use Power Automate or Albato to create flows that push new Outlook emails with specific labels into your Notion task database ¹⁰. Link Teams recordings to Notion to auto-generate meeting notes.

5. **Establish a Prompt Ledger:** Create a database with fields for prompt, model, context, outcome, salvage note and revision. After each GPT/Copilot session, log entries and use roll-ups to track which prompt patterns produce the best results.
6. **Experiment with SCAMPER:** Build a Notion template that prompts you to Substitute, Combine, Adapt, Modify, Put to another use, Eliminate and Reverse aspects of your idea. Use this for product ideation sessions and record outputs.
7. **Integrate VS Code tasks:** Install the Notion ToDo extension; connect using your integration key; and mirror your project's `Tasks` database.
8. **Reflect with cubic thought:** At the end of each week, use a Notion page to reflect on `Concept`, `Mechanism` and `Behaviour over time` for your major initiatives ⁷. Use AI to identify patterns, tension and protocols to refine.

6 Conclusion

Notion Business + AI is not just another note-taking tool; it is a **knowledge operating system**. By treating your workspace as an evolving set of **protocols**—like those described in the OverKill Hill manifesto—you can harness Notion's AI for structure and automation while still using ChatGPT or Copilot for deep reasoning and creativity. Integrate your existing tools via MCP and workflow automations, maintain a disciplined `Prompt Ledger`, and apply systematic ideation techniques such as SCAMPER to push your projects forward. This alignment of systems will help you realise your dual goals: driving enterprise architecture and building symbolic narrative systems.

¹ ² ⁹ ¹¹ Meet the new Notion AI | Notion

<https://www.notion.com/product/ai>

³ ¹² ¹³ Notion MCP – Notion Help Center

<https://www.notion.com/help/notion-mcp>

⁴ ¹⁰ Microsoft Office 365 (Copilot) and Notion integration. Connect Microsoft Office 365 (Copilot) to Notion - integrate easy with Albato

<https://albato.com/connect/microsoftoffice365-with-notion>

⁵ ⁶ ¹⁶ ¹⁷ I paired VSCode with Notion, and it turned out to be a genius combo

<https://www.xda-developers.com/pairing-vscode-with-notion/>

⁷ ¹⁴ Part I — Invocation: The Hill Awakens

<https://www.notion.so/51484f106d0a40aa86d983c2af012a9a>

⁸ ¹⁵ Notion AI Personalization Instructions

<https://www.notion.so/299812e0ced48032928af9a5ce17fb06>